

Seen You Around

It helps students start conversations with the classmates who sit near them.

Project Proposal

F26 — CSIS 3375 — Section 003 — Group 8

Team Members:

Akito Nakajima— Student ID: 300422052

Alex Kim— Student ID: 300427965

Team Lead:

Akito Nakajima

October 9th, 2026

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 APP DESCRIPTION

Seen You Around is an app that helps students start conversations with their classmates.

Some students take the same class for an entire semester without ever speaking to the person sitting next to them, simply because there is no natural reason to start a conversation. It is the classic "I've **Seen You Around**, but we've never talked" situation.

Seen You Around gives students that reason in two ways:

Real-time chat: If a student wants to talk during or after class, they can chat with nearby classmates right away.

Passing log: Students usually do not use their phones during a lecture, so the app quietly records which classmates were near them in class. Students can check this log later, whenever they want, and start a conversation from there.

The passing log is also useful after class ends. For example, a student may need help with an assignment, want to prepare for an exam, or need to form a project group. They can send a message to a classmate who was nearby, which makes it easier to start a face-to-face conversation when they meet in class.

1.2 NOVELTY

Existing nearby messaging apps usually lack a context, and campus social apps mostly connect people who already know each other.

Seen You Around combines three things: **physical closeness** in the classroom, a **shared course**, and a **record of who was nearby** that students can act on later.

Its novelty is not simply letting nearby student chat. It removes the pressure of the first move. A connection does not have to happen in the moment, because students can contact a classmate who was nearby whenever they need to.

1.3 TRANSFORMATIVE EXPERIENCE

Seen You Around aims to turn a classroom from a place where students sit beside strangers into a connected student community.

A student who has never spoken to the person beside them can look back at the people who were around them in class and realize that one of them is in the same course, working through the same assignment, or looking for a project partner. The app gives them a natural reason, and a low-pressure way, to reach out.

The desired experience is:

"The student you have seen around all semester is no longer just a stranger. They may become your classmate, study partner, or friend."

1.4 MOTTO

From "**Seen you around**" to "**Finally, hello.**".

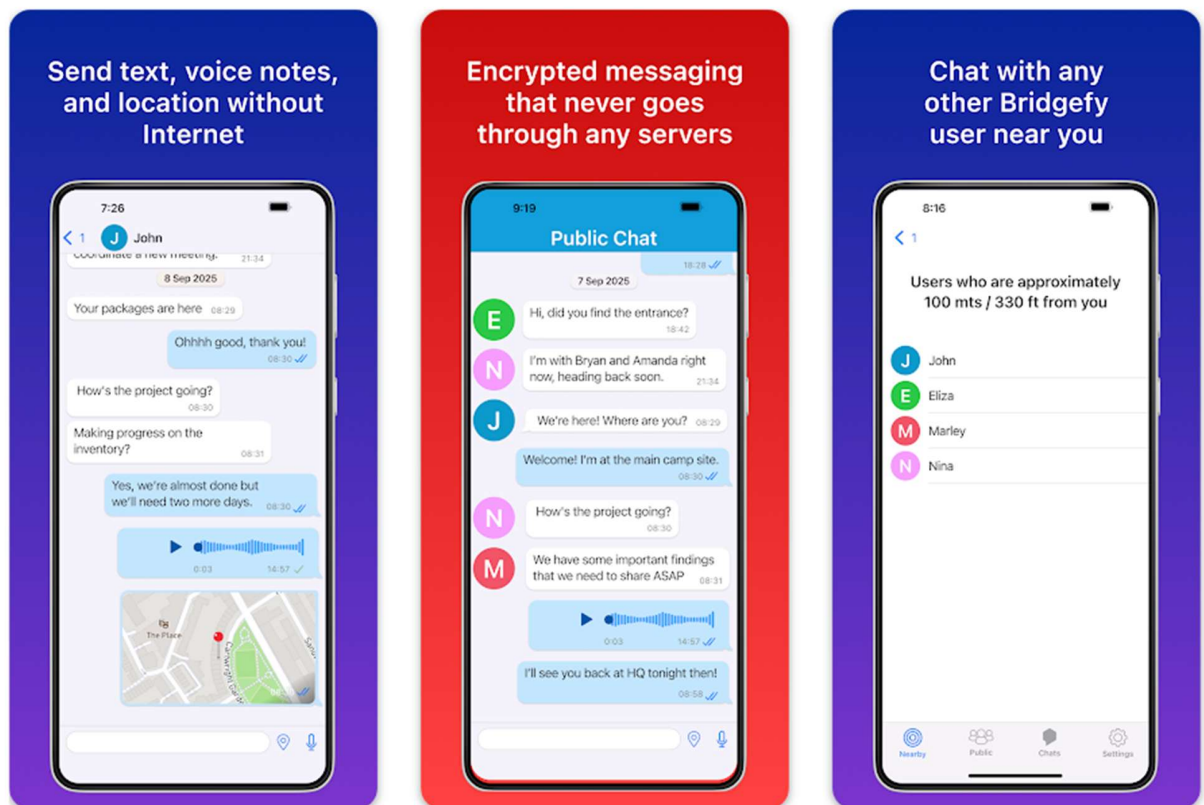
2. BACKGROUND RESEARCH

2.1 MARKET COMPETITORS

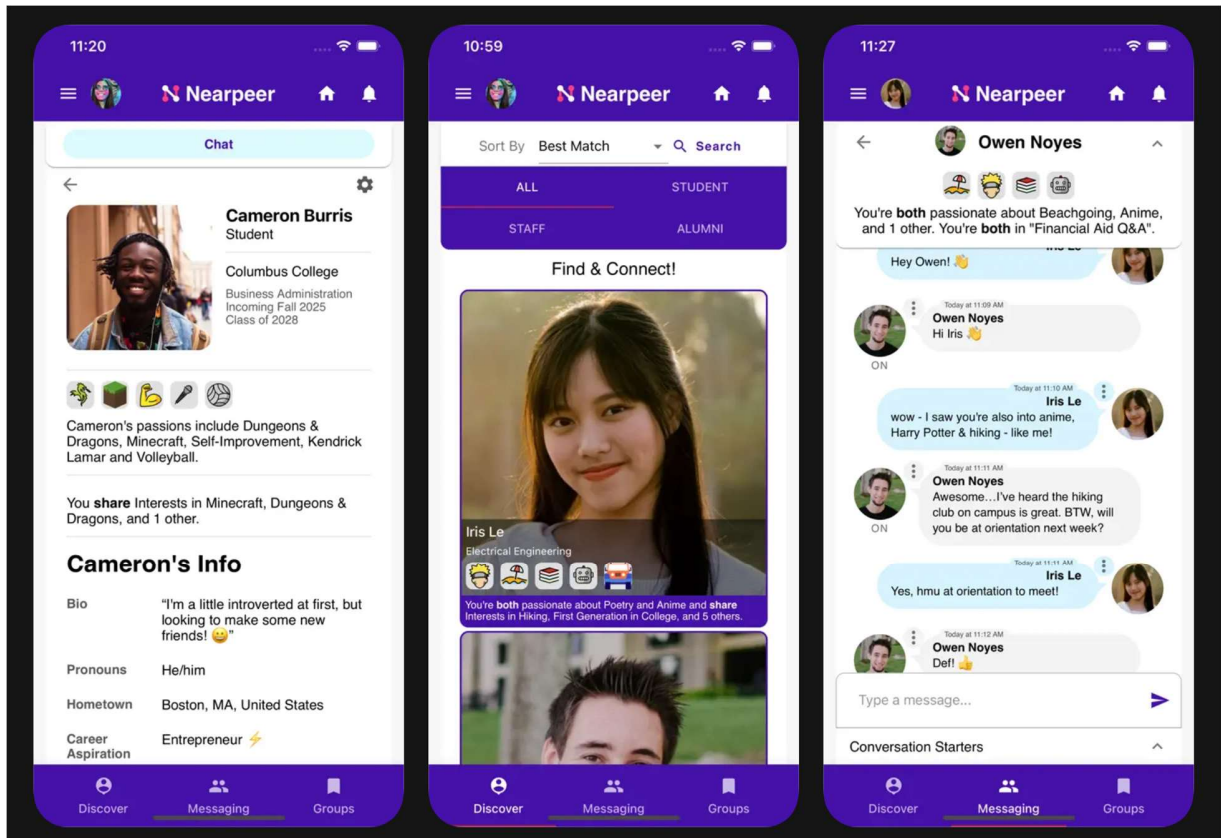
There are several apps that provide messaging, campus communities, study groups, or nearby communication. However, **general messaging apps** usually connect people who already know each other, while **nearby communication apps** often lack the shared context of being classmates. Seen You Around focuses specifically on helping students connect with classmates they have physically been near in class.

Several existing applications provide nearby messaging or student community features.

- Bridgefy: Allows users to communicate with **nearby people through Bluetooth** without an internet connection.



- Nearpeer: Helps **college students discover and connect** with classmates based on shared interests, majors, and experiences.



- CampusGroups: Provides **campus communities with group messaging, student organizations**, events, and communication tools.

CampusGroups: Your student engagement solution

Build community and improve student success with an app that students use daily to navigate campus life, academics, and services

[Explore CampusGroups →](#)
[Let's Talk →](#)

SOLUTIONS

Student Engagement
Streamline event and organization management, making involvement easy.

Student Retention
Connect students to community and support, then use data to show impact on retention

Student and Academic Success
Guides students through every stage of their academic and co-curricular journey.

Student Community and Belonging
Improve campus life with community-building software that helps students connect, engage, and thrive.

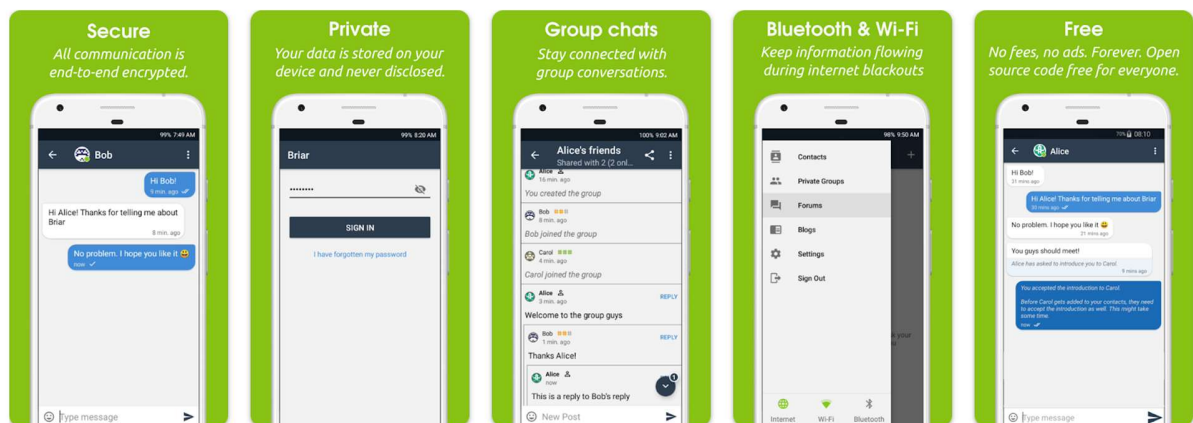
Student Communications
Centralize communications and access to essential information and resources.

Resource Management
Reduce administrators' workloads with automated processes and workflows.

- AirChat: Enables **nearby users to exchange messages** and participate in group chats through Bluetooth or Wi-Fi without internet access.



- Briar: Provides **secure peer-to-peer messaging** through Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, or the internet.



2.2 MARKET INSPIRATION

Seen You Around draws **inspiration from social networking, messaging, campus community, and nearby-device apps**. These apps provide useful ideas for features such as profiles, privacy controls, messaging, and discovering other users. Seen You Around brings these ideas into a classroom setting, where physical proximity and a shared course provide a natural reason for students to connect.

3. PACT FRAMEWORK

People: The main users are college and university students, **especially students who do not already know many** of their classmates or who are looking for study partners and academic support. The app should also consider students who may feel uncomfortable starting a conversation with someone they do not know.

Activities: Students **can discover classmates** who are nearby, see classmates they previously encountered through the passing log, start conversations, find study partners, and connect with students who share similar academic needs.

Context: The main context is **the classroom and surrounding campus environment**. Students may use the app before or after class, during breaks, or later when they want to contact someone they previously saw in class.

Technology: The app uses smartphones and nearby-device technology such as **Bluetooth** to recognize classmates who are physically nearby. Internet connectivity can support messaging, profiles, authentication, and other communication features.

4. VALUE PROPOSITION

Seen You Around helps students turn familiar faces in the classroom into real connections. Instead of requiring students to approach a stranger immediately, the app lets them discover nearby classmates and contact someone they have seen before when they have a reason to talk. By combining physical proximity, shared classroom context, and the passing log, Seen You Around makes the first conversation easier and more natural.

5. PRELIMINARY LIST OF FEATURES

The following features are preliminary ideas and may change during the design and research process:

- Study partner matching
- Study group creation
- Virtual study sessions
- Similar academic difficulty or interest matching
- Privacy and discoverability controls

The final feature set will be determined after further research, requirements gathering, user experience design, and prototype evaluation.

6. PROJECT CONTRACT

TEAM AGREEMENT

Both team members agree to work collaboratively and contribute fairly to the Seen You Around project.

The team will normally meet or review project progress approximately **once per week**. Additional discussions may take place whenever necessary.

The primary online communication method will be **WhatsApp**. Because both team members share classes and are normally on campus during weekdays from Monday through Thursday, project discussions may also take place in person when convenient.

Each member agrees to:

- Communicate regularly about project progress.
- Complete agreed work within a reasonable time.
- Inform the other member if there is a problem or delay.
- Share research, design ideas, and project materials.
- Review major project decisions together.
- Maintain an individual work log.
- Keep project materials organized in the shared GitHub repository.

The team recognizes that responsibilities may change as the project progresses.

AGREEMENT

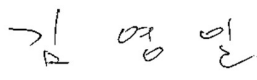
By signing below, both members agree to the project working arrangements described above.

Akito Nakajima

Signature: 

Date: October 7th, 2026

Alex Kim

Signature: 

Date: October 7th, 2026

7. AI USE SECTION

The project team may use AI as a supporting tool during research, writing, brainstorming, and documentation. AI-generated information will be reviewed and modified by the team before being included in the project.

AI Tool Name	Version / Account Type	Specific Use	Value Addition
ChatGPT	Latest available version — Plus account	Search for similar apps and their features.	Select relevant information
		Suggest possible app names.	Organize the document
		Adapt AI-generated content to the project concept.	Improve proposal writing
		Help structure project documentation.	Add project-specific ideas
Claude	Mainly Sonnet 5.5 — Fee account	Generate and narrow down app ideas.	Faster, broader ideation.
		Pressure-test ideas.	Critical thinking, not just agreement.
		Refine the final concept.	Better, tighter writing.
		Draft and revise proposal text in English.	

The relevant AI prompt history will be included in the Appendix.

8. WORK HOURS LOG

MEMBER: AKITO

Date	Number of Hours	Description of Work Done
September 24, 2026	0.67	Brainstormed initial app ideas and compared possible directions for the project
October 1, 2026	0.25	Project Idea Meeting
October 3, 2026	1.25	Created the project schedule, including milestones, task breakdown, and deadlines
October 5, 2026	2.00	Finalized the app idea and defined its main concept, target users, and core features
October 7, 2026	2.00	Wrote the proposal document mainly introduction and preliminary list of features, and prepared the materials for submission

MEMBER: ALEX

Date	Number of Hours	Description of Work Done
September 24, 2026	0.67	Brainstormed initial app ideas and compared possible directions for the project
October 1, 2026	0.25	Project Idea Meeting
October 1, 2026	1.00	Reviewed the project proposal requirements and prepared an initial project proposal preview and structure.
October 2, 2026	2.00	Prepared the first draft of the app project proposal, including the app concept, PACT framework, value proposition, and project organization.
October 3, 2026	1.00	Set up and organized the GitHub repository.
October 5, 2026	1.50	Prepared regarding GitHub repository, README file, project contract, AI use, and proposal preparation.
October 8, 2026	3.00	Reviewed and revised the project proposal, including market competitors, PACT framework, value proposition, and overall project structure.

APPENDIX A — AI PROMPT HISTORY

MEMBER: AKITO

- UX/UI の授業でプロジェクトがあります。アイデアを一緒に考えてください。
Project Goals You will be DESIGNING a full-fledged prototype in FIGMA for a novel app with high utility providing a transformative experience to the user. THIS IS NOT A CODING PROJECT. You are creating a hard coded prototype in Figma prototype. The goal is to come up with a novel idea with high utility based on market background research, and identify the unique transformative experience you would provide for the user. Then, you will adhere to and apply design process discussed in class to create the prototype for this novel app.
Choosing projects The project idea can be any idea that excites and interests you as long as it is: • It is a novel, marketable app – it has high novelty and utility compared to market competitors. • It provides a unique, transformative experience for the user Note that the end deliverable of the prototype is not just novel in terms of User Interface but provides unique utility and experience. Also, I want teams to be ambitious, creative and think outside the box. If your prototype can be easily programmed with your CSIS 3175 knowledge alone, the prototype is not ambitious enough in terms of UI/UX user experience.
- 別の分野をもう少し見たいです。
- すれ違う人と「今だけ」つながるアプリの掘り下げをお願いします。今だけな必要はないと思います。ライブ会場やクラブ、その場にいる人との会話のきっかけになるのはいいのではないのでしょうか？
- Bluetooth で近くにいる人とチャットするアプリを目標としたいです。目的は教室、ナイトクラブ、コンサート等、人が集まることで新たな繋がり・友だちを作ることが目的です。
- 学校・教室での利用シーンに特化しようと思います。
- 近くのクラスメートとの会話のきっかけを作るチャットをコア機能に、Project Goal を達成するための他の機能を検討します。
候補を上げてください
- ちょっとまだ弱いですね。まずはコア機能の強化から検討にしたいと思います。授業中は基本的にスマホは見ないので、その中でどのように近接クラスメートとの話始めるきっかけになれるかを考えましょう。
- 別のきっかけ、特にすれ違い通信を活かした機能を検討したです。
- 英語のチェック、内容の添削をお願いします。
In-classroom Chat App
-What is this?
Discover people around you in classrooms possibly Bluetooth communication distance
Why is this?
Sometimes people need a reason to start conversations with their classmates in classrooms. This app can give users the reason.

And more

It can have more school oriented features such as

- 段落形式にまとめてください

And more も一旦想定で出してください

- アプリの名前を検討したいです。ClassLink 的な名前で、AppStore や GooglePlay にアプリと被らないようにしたいです。リアルタイム・すれ違い通信でクラスメートに話すきっかけを与える感じにしたいです。

- 以下の文章をベースに Seen You Around の内容を反映させてください

1.1 App Description

ClassConnect is a classroom-focused social and study connection app designed to help students discover and communicate with classmates who are physically nearby.

Students often attend the same class for an entire semester without speaking to many of the people around them. Although they share the same course, assignments, deadlines, and academic challenges, there may be no natural opportunity to start a conversation.

ClassConnect provides that missing connection. Using nearby-device technology such as Bluetooth, students can discover other ClassConnect users in the same classroom or nearby study environment. The app can then provide opportunities to start conversations, form study groups, share study sessions, and connect with classmates facing similar academic challenges.

Rather than functioning as a general social networking or anonymous Bluetooth chat application, ClassConnect focuses specifically on the student community experience.

1.2 Novelty

Existing messaging and social networking applications primarily help people communicate with users they already know. General Bluetooth chat applications can connect nearby users, but they usually lack the educational and classroom context needed to create meaningful student connections.

ClassConnect combines physical proximity, shared classroom context, and academic purpose.

The novelty of the concept is not simply allowing nearby students to chat. Its purpose is to transform physical proximity in a classroom into an opportunity for meaningful academic and social interaction.

1.3 Transformative Experience

ClassConnect aims to transform a classroom from a place where students simply sit near strangers into a more connected student community.

For example, a student may realize that another person sitting nearby is taking the same course, struggling with the same topic, preparing for the same exam, or looking for a study partner. ClassConnect gives students a natural reason to make the first connection.

The desired experience is:

“The student sitting next to you is no longer just a stranger. They may become your classmate, study partner, or friend.”

1.4 Motto

Connect. Study. Support.

- イメージ足したので清書してください

Seen You Around is an app that helps students start conversations with their classmates.

Some students share the same class for an entire semester without ever speaking to the person sitting next to them, simply because there's no natural reason to start a conversation. It's like "I've seen you around..., but I've

never talked you..."

Seen You Around gives students that reason in two ways:

Real-time chat: If a student wants to talk during or after class, they can chat with nearby classmates right away.

Passing log: Students usually do not use their phones during a lecture, so the app quietly records which classmates were near them in class. Students can check this log later, whenever they want, and start a conversation from there.

The passing log is also useful after class ends. For example, a student may need help with an assignment, want to prepare for an exam, or need to form a project group. They can send a message to a classmate who was nearby, which makes it easier to start a face-to-face conversation when they meet in class.

- ノベルティ書き換えました。

Existing nearby messaging apps don't usually have contexts, and campus social apps mostly serve people who are already friends.

Seen You Around combines three things: physical closeness in the classroom, a shared course, and a record of who was nearby that students can act on later.

Its novelty is not simply letting nearby students chat. It removes the pressure of the first move: a connection does not have to happen in the moment, because a classmate who was seen around can be contacted whenever needed.

- モットーを一緒に考えてください
- From "Seen you around" to "Let's talk." こんな感じでいいですが、Let's Talk をもっとエモくしてください
- UX デザインのプロジェクトにおいて、私が Claude を使用している方法について英語で Specific Use と Value Addition を回答してください
- 以下の表を MD に変換してください
Date Number of Hours Description of Work Done
September 24, 2026 0.67 Idea thinking
October 1, 2026 0.25 Project meeting
October 3, 2026 1.25 Create Project schedule
October 5, 2026 2.00 Finalized the idea
October 7, 2026 2.00 Proposal document, Submission preparation
- Description of Work Don をもうちょっとだけ詳しく書いてください
- 次を考えてください。 § Provide a one line description of what the app does

MEMBER: ALEX

- Create a proposal first draft by the instruction. Project Contract should be one another pages with both names and AI Use Section should be one table, and Work hour table should be one table. The AIAS section. I think only AI tool name is ChatGPT, and there is an appendix. Property history must be saved in the appendix, but not be

serious. So, for example, first, it is, yeah, in the contents: search for the similar app and its features. Second is search for the app name, yeah, like this comment inside the table, not the detail, and work hours it, just write three sentences, three lines, and the description of work done. First, project proposal preview. Second, proposal first draft. Third, mail to Akito. Each of number of hours is two hours, and date is from October 1st, 2nd, 3rd. Just writing down for three lines, and show me all of them in the canvas, not in the file, so I can correct or changing.

- Suggest possible names for an app that helps classmates connect and start conversations with nearby students.
- Prepare a short and simple README.md file based on the professor's GitHub repository requirements.
- Add a preliminary list of features to the README.md file.
- Explain whether a GitHub repository can be renamed later after the group number is confirmed.
- Explain how to add a team member as a collaborator to the GitHub repository.
- Search for similar market competitors and provide each app's name and main feature in one sentence.
- Revise and organize the AI Use section, including Specific Use and Value Addition.
- Revise the descriptions of work completed for the individual work log.
- Organize the individual work log into a Markdown table.